

SHOWCASE

Puma RS-Computer Shoe

Bringing back retro technology in a reinvented form has been the flavour of the season. Joining the ranks of the NES Classic, PlayStation Classic and more, The RS-Computer shoe from Puma is being reissued by the manufacturer. If you're unfamiliar with that name, the RS-Computer shoe was a smart shoe released in 1986 that came with technology in its heels. The heel on the RS (Running System) came embedded with sensors that could track the time, distance and calories expended and could communicate the results once connected to any Apple



IIe, Commodore 64 using a 16-pin cord. The new iteration of the shoe, that comes more than 30 years after the original, retains a cable but uses it for charging the shoe via USB. As with most wearable fitness devices today, it comes with Bluetooth

that lets it connect to Android and iOS devices and transfer data to a dedicated RS-Computer shoe app. To maintain the retro feel, the app uses 8-bit graphics in its interface. Each shoe comes with a 3-axis accelerometer to measure the steps and is capable of storing a month's worth of data. A couple of LED indicators show you your performance and battery levels. Only 86 pairs of these shoes will ever be made, signifying its launch year.



Postmates Serve

Autonomous technology has been taking over numerous areas, especially when it comes to navigation. On-demand delivery company Postmates has decided to incorporate autonomous navigation into its fleet with Serve, a small autonomous robot that can navigate sidewalks and roads to deliver food, packages and other smaller items in urban settings. You're probably wondering if something like this is even feasible since you've been hearing the word 'autonomous' come and go for ages. Well, the Serve has been tested with a prototype fleet for thousands of packages. Apart from the adorable looks, the first version of serve packs some impressive numbers for its size. It comes with the capability to carry 50 pounds and travel upto 30 miles on one charge, using tech from partners like Velodyne Lidar and NVIDIA to navigate the surroundings. Along with the Velodyne Lidar sensors, from NVIDIA it uses the XAVIER processor. For interactivity, the Postmates Serve packs a touchscreen and a set of cameras. When it comes to an autonomous robot going around your city, you would want it to have the ability to communicate with you as well. For that, the Serve comes with dynamic lighting in the eyes and a light ring on top that can indicate things like a change in direction.

Monopoly Luxury Edition

If you've already checked out SKOAR this month, you'd notice that there's a full-fledged review of Monopoly: Cheater's Edition. The game landed in our test labs this month and had us hooked for quite a while.

So you can imagine how reasonable a resulting obsession with different editions of Monopoly is. Our searches brought us to one such edition that is meant for the uber-luxurious aficionados of the game, the Monopoly Luxury Edition. The actual 22" x 22" x 4" game board is a cabinet fashioned out of wood with burl veneer panels. Die-cast metal is used for the decorative 'Monopoly' plaque up front



as well as the handles to the drawers. The die rolling area at the centre is covered in faux leather whereas all the signage in the game, including the game path, are made with gold foil stamping. The drawers on two sides offer an elegant storage place for the notes, houses and hotels that the bank governs. Along with the houses and hotels, even the player tokens are made out of die-cast metal. There's a leather title deed card holder included as well for storing the cards when they are not in play. According to the manufacturer, all the cards in the game have a premium finish. Priced at \$250, this board will easily outlast its cardboard counterparts. However, will it survive your temper after you've discovered that your friend cheated on a deal carried out three rounds ago? There are some things money can't buy.